

Russell Dudek

APPLIED AI STRATEGIST | FORWARD-DEPLOYED AI OPERATOR

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Operator-technologist who enters complex work, makes the operating reality visible, and builds AI-enabled mechanisms that connect business outcomes, human authority, evidence, recovery, and adoption.

FORWARD-DEPLOYED OWNERSHIP	HANDS-ON AI WORKFLOWS	REGULATED COMPLEXITY
Executive-to-operator translation and accountable execution.	Agentic patterns, retrieval, human review, evaluation, and governance.	High-reliability electronics, autonomous systems, quality, and safety.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet

Director of Operations | 2025-Present

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works directly in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor | 2017-Present

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Works across AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, and workflow design.

Amazon

Operations Management / Site Leader | 2014-2018

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

Compunetics

Director of Operations and Engineering Management | 2000-2013

- Progressed through R&D, program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.
- Published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

ROLE-ALIGNED OPERATING MECHANISMS

Outcome contract	Name the operating result, accountable owner, and evidence before selecting the tool.
Human authority	Expose the decisions people retain and the escalation conditions that require judgment.
Evaluation and recovery	Instrument quality, exceptions, rollback, and learning so the workflow can operate under consequence.
Platform return	Capture reusable context, controls, evaluation patterns, and change-learning from each engagement.

COMPLEMENTARY OPERATING DEPTH

ZeusVu

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations | 2018-2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and designed medical-delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

Cardinal Building Products

Regional Director | 2021-2023

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows; advanced AI-enhanced transportation and route-planning concepts.

Enviro Social Capital

Chairman of the Board | 2014-2017

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE

CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair | 2012-2016

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.
- Organized conferences, seminars, business tours, and technical programming.

VALON FIT MAP

Embedded operating ownership	Vape-Jet, Amazon, Cardinal
Hands-on AI workflow design	DudeWorth, Python, JavaScript, TensorFlow, RAG, human review
Regulated judgment	ZeusVu safety, Compunetics quality systems and DoD work
Executive and operator change	Cross-functional operations, public-private leadership, technical programming
Context that compounds	Standard work, decision frameworks, dashboards, quality systems, talks and playbooks

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Agentic AI | LLM workflows | RAG patterns | Human-in-the-loop design | Python | SQL | JavaScript | TensorFlow | Tableau | ERP/Odoo | Jira | Confluence | HubSpot | Slack | GIS and mapping workflows

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS

University of Pittsburgh - Bachelor of Science. Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

Credentials: Google AI Essentials | IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner | Six Sigma Certification | OSHA 10

TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

Published industry articles, delivered technical talks, participated in the HyperTransport Consortium, and led regional IEEE programming. Academic work is indexed through Russell's Google Scholar profile: scholar.google.com/citations?user=yHQSVD8AAAAJ

HOW I WOULD CONTRIBUTE

Enter the live operation, define the outcome and authority boundary, build the smallest real workflow, operate it to evidence, and return the reusable context, controls, evaluation, and recovery pattern to ValonOS.

EVIDENCE I WOULD INSTRUMENT

Operating outcome	Cycle time, rework, resolution quality, and measurable completion of the target workflow.
Trust and control	Compliance exceptions, traceability, human-review quality, and recovery performance.
Adoption and learning	Operator acceptance, recurring issues, decision-record completeness, and reusable platform learning.

BUILD THE WORKFLOW. RETURN THE PRIMITIVE.

Each embedded engagement should deliver a measurable operating outcome and leave ValonOS with reusable context, controls, evaluation, and recovery patterns.